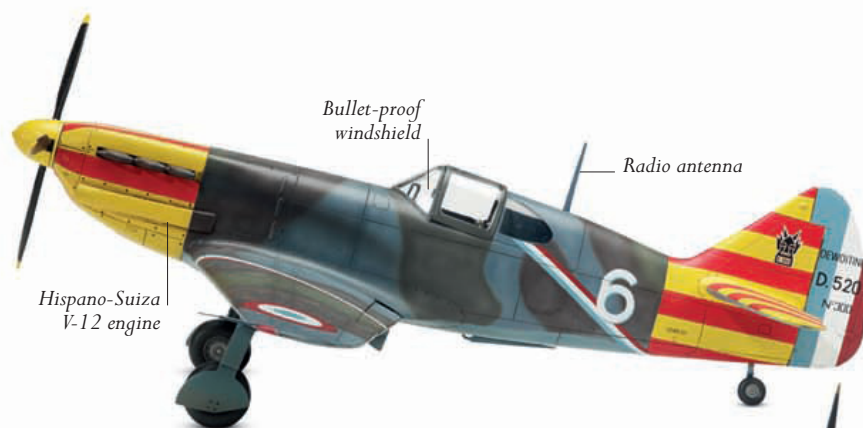
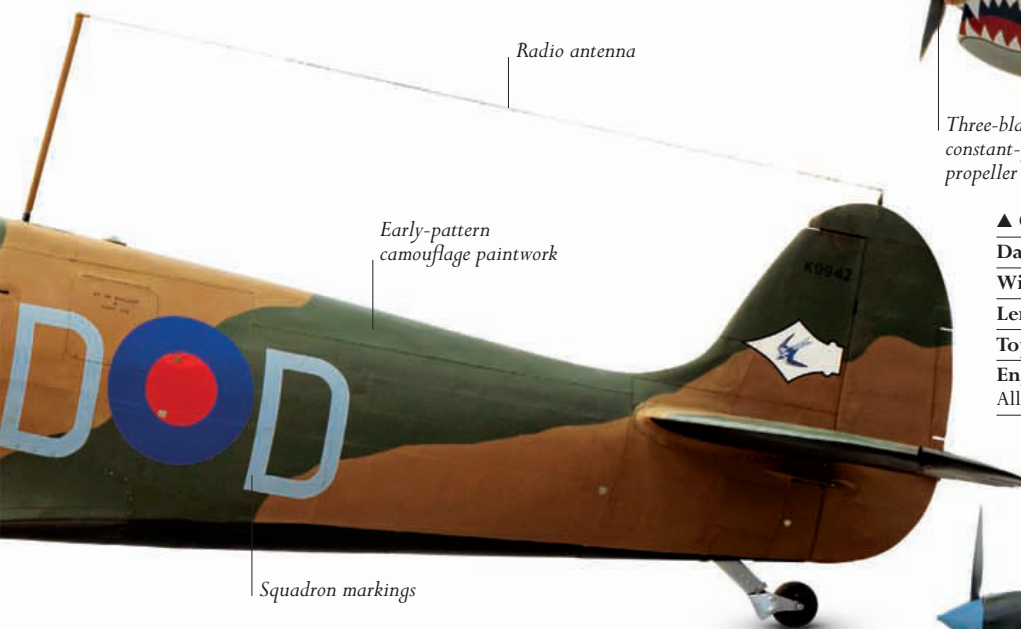




◀ DEWOITINE D.520

Date 1940 **Origin** France
Wingspan 10.2m (33½ft)
Length 8.6m (28¼ft)
Top speed 535kph (330mph)
Engine 687.6kW (935hp)
 Hispano-Suiza 12Y 45 in-line V-12

Without doubt the most capable fighter aircraft produced in France, the D.520 was a match for the Bf 109Es it fought in 1940, but only 400 had been produced before France capitulated. It had a service ceiling of 10,500m (34,500ft) and a range of 1,530km (950 miles).



▲ CURTISS P-40 WARHAWK

Date 1941 **Origin** US
Wingspan 11.38m (37½ft)
Length 10.15m (33½ft)
Top speed 550kph (340mph)
Engine 882.5kW (1,200hp)
 Allison V-1710-81 in-line V-12

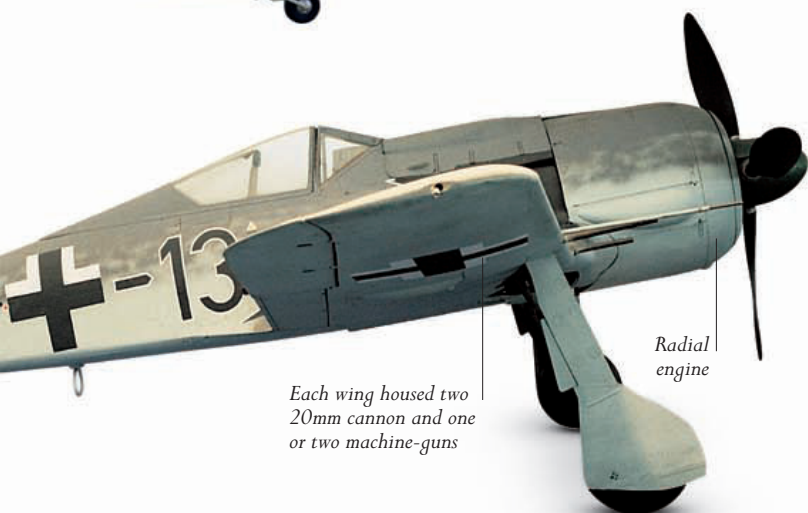
While respected for its agility, the Warhawk, even in its later variants, could not compete with the Messerschmitt Bf 109 or the Focke-Wulf Fw 190, which could attain higher altitudes. Nonetheless, it was the mainstay of the UK's Desert Air Force in North Africa, and saw action in China and the Southwest Pacific.



◀ HAWKER HURRICANE

Date 1940 **Origin** UK
Wingspan 12.2m (40ft)
Length 9.85m (32¼ft)
Top speed 550kph (340mph)
Engine 871.5kW (1,185hp)
 Rolls-Royce Merlin XX V-12 in-line

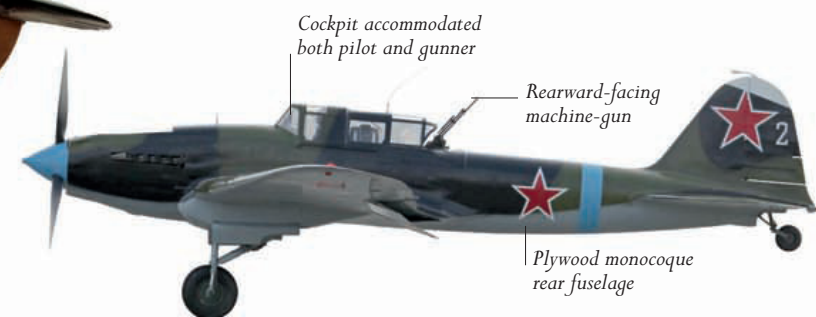
The Hurricane was something of an anomaly: a modern interceptor with a fuselage covered with fabric rather than sheet aluminium. It was much easier to produce and to repair than its all-metal Spitfire counterpart.



▲ ILYUSHIN IL-2 "SHTURMOVIK"

Date 1942 **Origin** Soviet Union
Wingspan 14.6m (47¾ft)
Length 11.6m (38ft)
Top speed 410kph (255mph)
Engine 1,250.3kW (1,700hp) Mikulin AM-38F in-line V-12

Built around a 700kg (1,540lb) armoured shell that contained the crew, engine, and fuel tank, the IL-2, the "flying tank", was designed purely as a ground-attack aircraft. Over 42,000 were constructed.



▲ NAKAJIMA KI-43 HAYABUSA "OSCAR"

Date 1942 **Origin** Japan
Wingspan 10.84m (35½ft)
Length 8.92m (29¼ft)
Top speed 530kph (330mph)
Engine 845.8kW (1,150hp) Nakajima Ha-115 2-bank 14-cylinder radial

The Japanese Army's equivalent to the IJN's Mitsubishi A6M, the Hayabusa (Peregrine Falcon) weighed just 2.3 tonnes (2½ tons). Due to its light weight it was highly manoeuvrable and had an impressive rate of climb. The Hayabusa was well-regarded by its pilots, even though it was slow by contemporary standards and poorly armed.